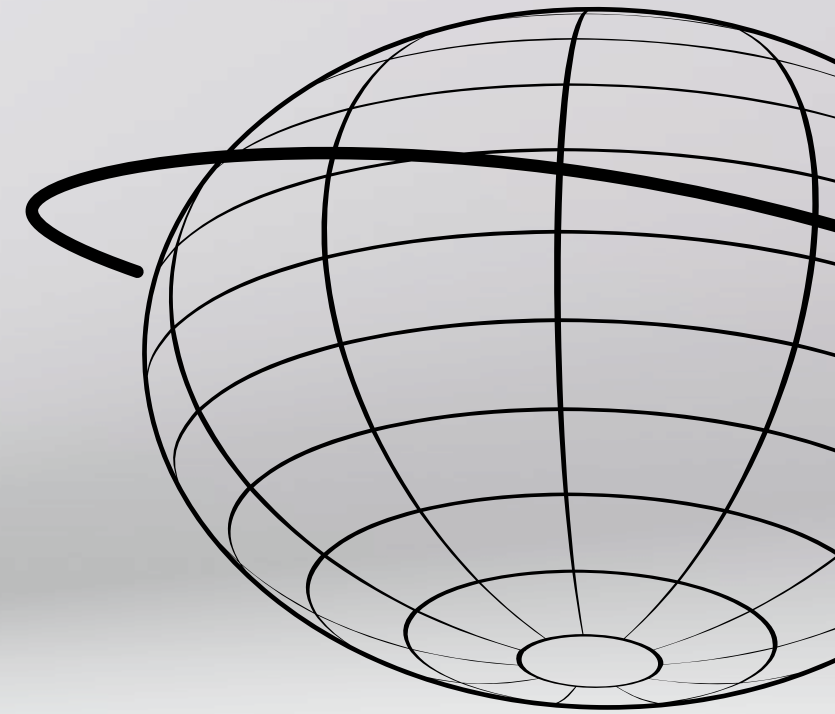


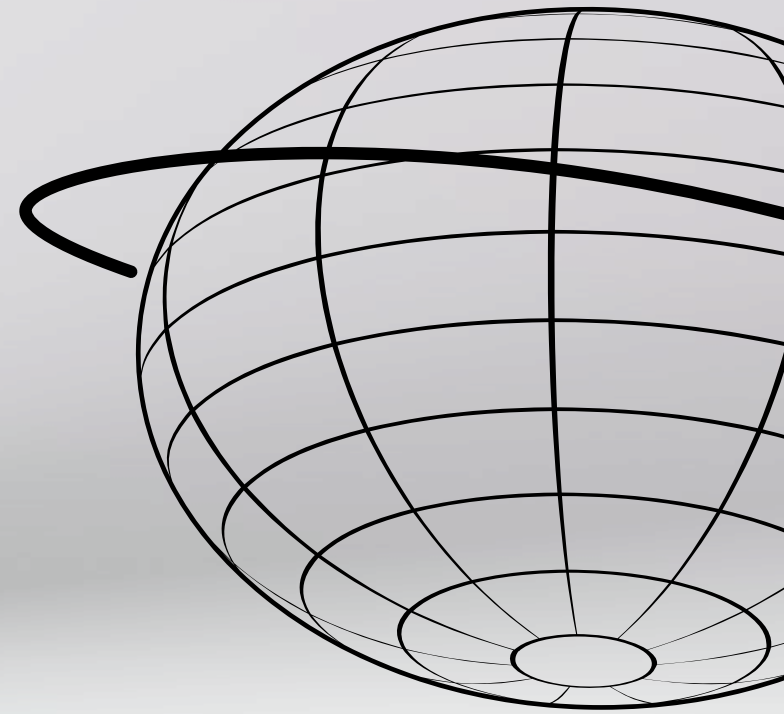
PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

***PROTECTING USERS FROM SOCIAL
ENGINEERING ATTACKS***



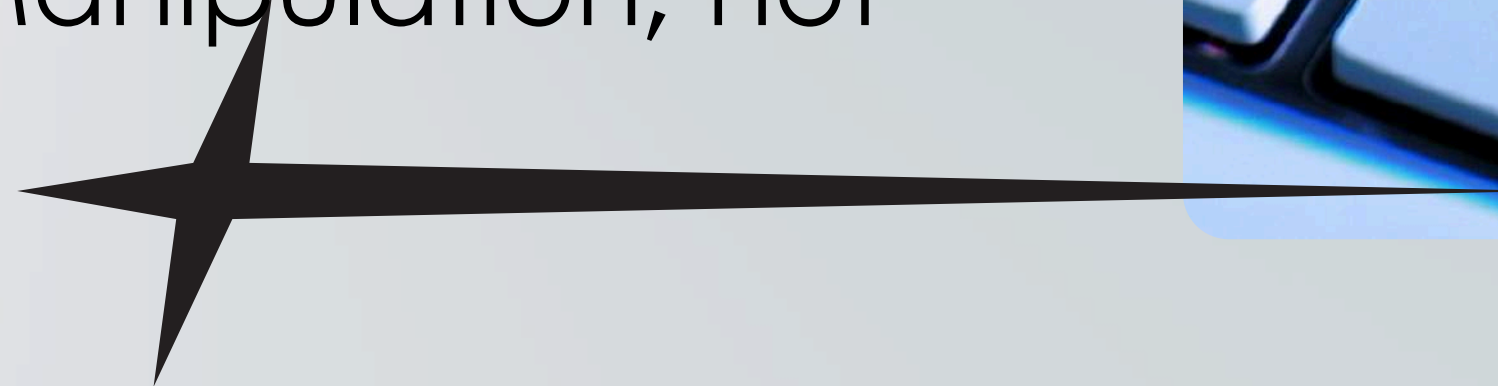
**Prepared By: Joseph Agyapong
Role: Cybersecurity Intern
Organisation: CodeAlpha
Date: 30.01.2026**

- What is Phishing?
- Why Phishing is Dangerous?
- Common Types of Phishing
- How to Recognize Phishing Emails
- Identifying Fake Websites
- Social Engineering Techniques
- Best Practices & Prevention
- Real-World Examples
- Interactive Quiz
- Key Takeaways



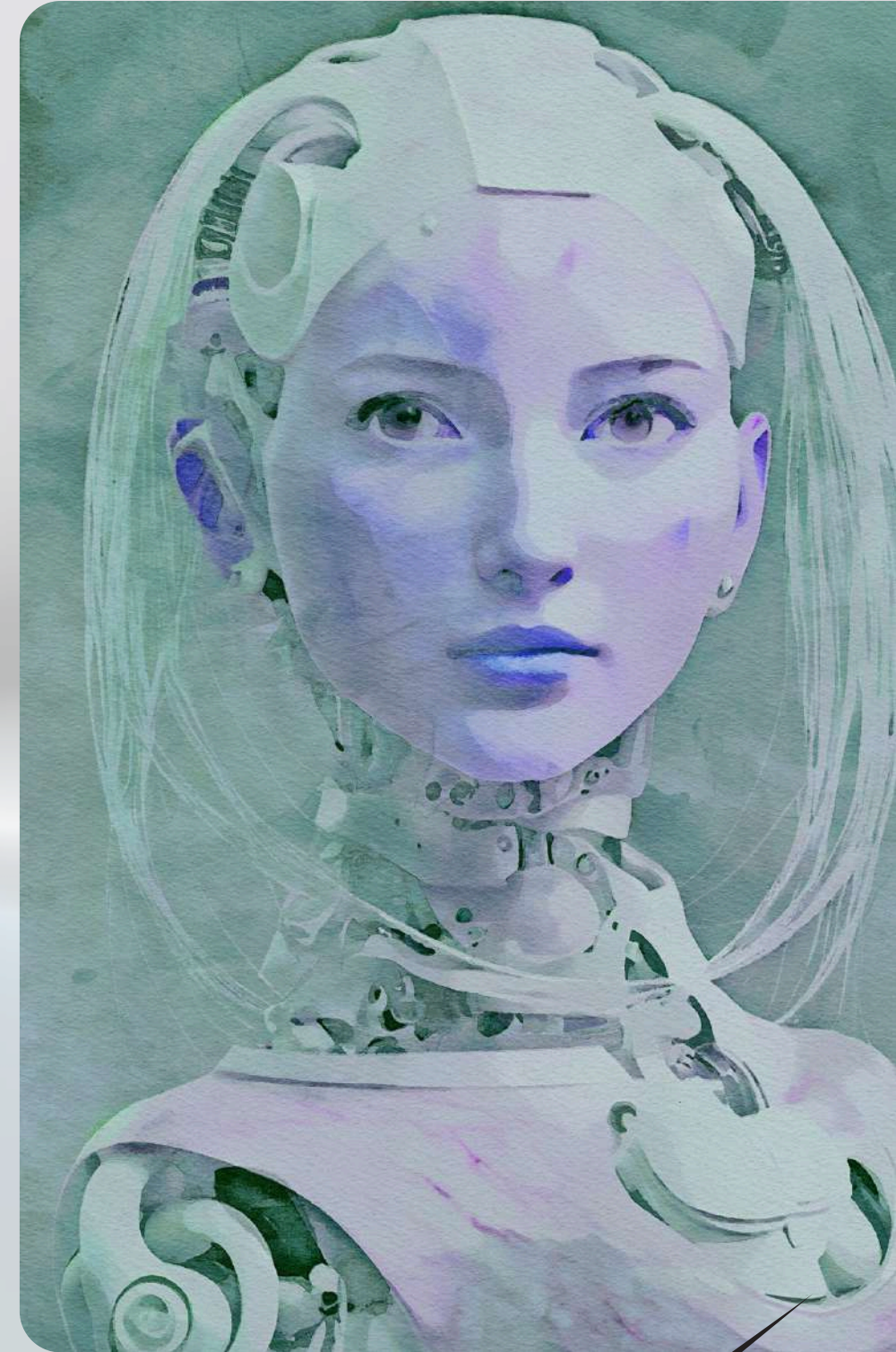
What is Phishing?

- ***Phishing is a cyberattack that targets users***
- Attackers impersonate target Organisations
- **Goal:** Steal sensitive information such as Passwords, Bank details, Login credentials
- Protecting Users from Social Engineering Attacks
- Relies on Deception and Manipulation, not hacking tools



Why is Phishing Dangerous?

- Leads to account compromise
- Can cause Financial loss
- Enables Identity theft
- Often the entry point for:
 - Ransomware
 - Data breaches
 - Corporate Network Attacks



Common Types of Phishing Attacks

Email Phishing

Fake emails from
trusted brands

Spear Phishing

Targeted Attacks
on specific
individuals

Whaling

Attacks targeting
Executives or
Managers

Smishing

Phishing via
SMS/Text Messages

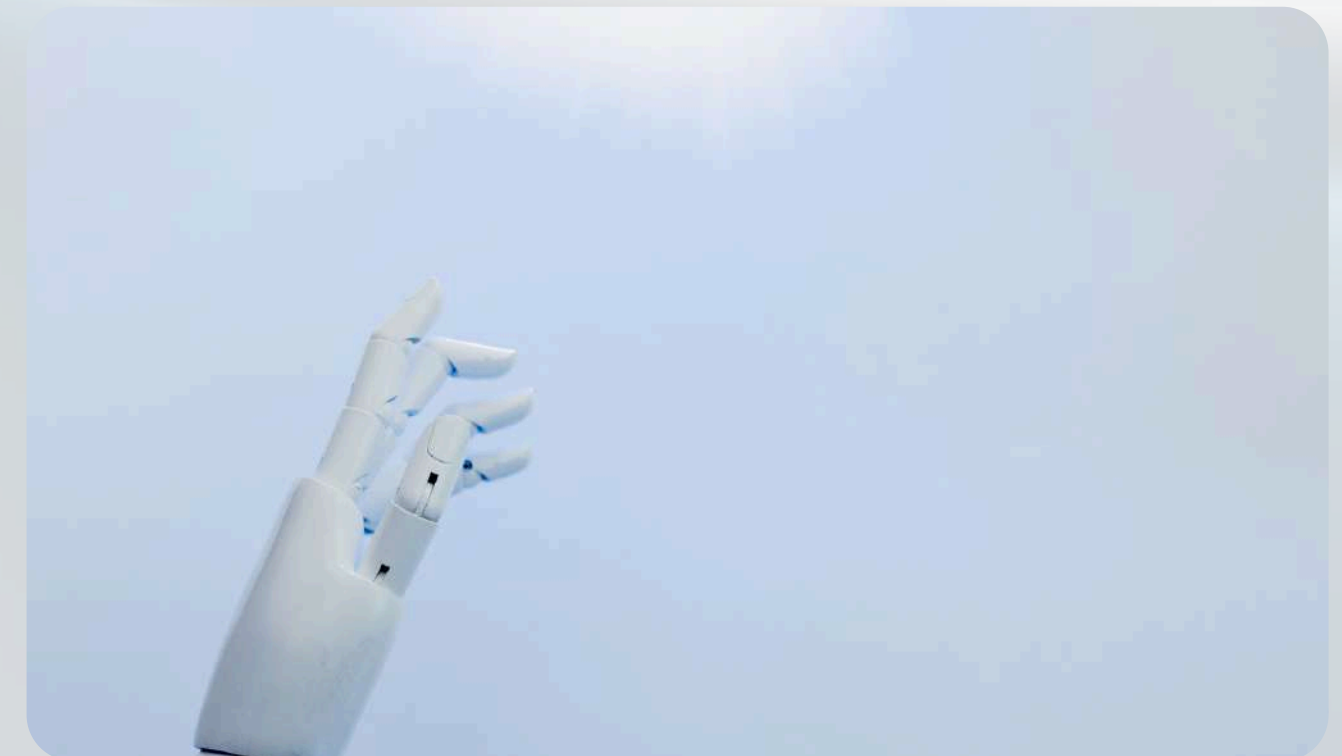
Vishing

Voice phishing via
phone calls

How to Recognise Phishing Emails

- Suspicious or unknown sender address
- Generic greetings (e.g., “Dear User”)
- Urgent or threatening language
- Unexpected attachment or links
- Poor Spelling or Grammar

Example: “Your account will be suspended within 24 hours.”



Identifying Fake Websites

- Misspelled domain names (eg, paypa1.com)
- No HTTPS OR Invalid Security Certificate
- Poor design or broken links
- Login pages asking for unnecessary information
- ***Tips: Always check the full URL before logging in***



Social Engineering Tactics used by Attackers



- **Urgency:** “Act now or loss access”.
- **Fear:** “Your account has been compromised”.
- **Authority:** Pretending to be IT,HR or Management
- **Trust:** Using Known brands or Colleague names.
- **Curiosity:** “See who viewed your profile”.

Best Practices to Avoid Phishing

- Verify sender entity before responding
- Do not click suspicious links
- Hover over links to preview URLs
- Never share passwords via Email
- Enable Multi-factor Authentication (MFA)
- Report suspicious emails immediately





What to do if you suspect Phishing

- Do NOT Click links or attachments
- Do NOT reply to the email
- Report the message to IT or Secuirty team
- Delete the email after reporting

Early reporting prevents wider compromise

Real-World Phishing Example

Scenario:

An Employee receives an email appearing to be from Microsoft requesting a password reset.

What went wrong:

- Link was clicked without verification
- Credentials entered on a fake website

Impact:

- Account compromise
- Unauthorised system access



Interactive Quiz

Question:

Which of the following is a sign of a phishing email?

- A) Personalized greeting
- B) Urgent threat message
- C) Valid company domain
- D) Expected attachment

Correct Answer: B



Quiz - Scenario Based

Scenario:

You receive an email from “IT SUPPORT” asking for your login.

What should you do?

- Ignore and report the email
- Reply with your credentials
- Click on the link immediately

Correct Action: Ignore and report the email



Key Takeaways

- Phishing targets people, not systems
- Always verify messages before trusting them
- Be cautious with links and attachments
- When in doubt, report it.



Security starts with awareness

Thank You

Stay Safe, Stay Smart

Email:
josephagya122@gmail.com

LinkedIn:

